

Creation



Two hands reach across empty space and do not quite meet. Nearness was the design. The gap is not the design.

OPEN PART I BY SAYING

For four weeks, start with God. Creation, love, mercy, and grace are not a warm-up. They are who He is. Do not rush past Him to get to our problem. The cross will mean more if the room knows the God who gave His Son.

Before you gather

- Read Day 1, Creation, in The Visual Gospel. Do not reteach the essay.
- Read Psalm 8:3–6 in your Bible. The excerpt below is only a backup.
- Your people should already have answered the day's reflection questions. Do not ask those again.
- Leave with a name. The missional challenge only works if someone is named before you pray.

1 · ICEBREAKER · 7 MIN

Open the room

What is something you made with your hands that you were glad to finish?

Leader. Let them name something ordinary. Then open Psalm 8. The psalm worships the God who made the heavens with His fingers. Genesis 1 tells how: He spoke, and it was so, in six days, and He made man in His image. Read it as history. Then worship. Say that passing is allowed, especially the first few weeks.

2 · THE WORD · 8 MIN

See it, then say it

IF YOU NEED THE WORDS

Say: God made the heavens and the earth in six days, as Genesis records. He made us in His image to know Him and to worship Him.

DEFINITION, FROM THE BOOK

Creation is God making the whole world and everything in it. He made people in a special way so we could know, love, and reflect Him.

IN THE ORIGINAL LANGUAGE

Hebrew *asah* — to fashion, accomplish, or produce. Greek *poieō* — to make, to create, to do.

MEMORY VERSE · GENESIS 1:26–27

Then God said, “Let us make man in our image, after our likeness.” So God created man in his own image, in the image of God he created him; male and female he created them.

Together, open the flashcard for Creation. Say the word, the definition, and the verse once. Then put the phone away.

3 · OPEN THE BIBLE · 15 MIN

Psalm 8:3–6

The memory verse is Genesis 1:26–27. That chapter is history. God created in six days by His word, and He made man male and female in His image. Stay in Psalm 8 for the questions. Ask what the text says before anyone talks about how big the sky makes them feel. Feelings are not the authority. But God gave us these words. Do not reteach the journal.

When I look at your heavens, the work of your fingers, the moon and the stars, which you have set in place, what is man that you are mindful of him, and the son of man that you care for him? Yet you have made him a little lower than the heavenly beings and crowned him with glory and honor. You have given him dominion over the works of your hands; you have put all things under his feet.

Have two readers if you can. Bibles open. The excerpt is only here so a forgotten Bible does not stop the night.

From the passage

1. In Psalm 8, what belongs to God alone, and what does He give to human beings?

CORE

Leader. The heavens are the work of His fingers. He set the moon and stars in place. To man He gives mindfulness, care, a crown of glory and honor, and dominion. Dignity is a gift from the Maker. We did not seize it.

2. The writer asks, 'What is man that you are mindful of him?' Is this a boast about us, or worship of God?

Leader. It is worship. We are small. God is great, and yet He cares. We were made for God. A talk about creation that never becomes praise has missed the psalm.

4 · AROUND THE ROOM · 20 MIN

A conversation this chapter did not assign

3. Colossians 1:16 says all things were created through the Son and for Him. What is wrong with a gospel that starts with us and our needs?

Leader. Jesus is the Creator and the goal of all things. He is King. We exist for Him. Worship is the point. A gospel that starts with what we get has the subject wrong.

4. Genesis 3:15 promises an offspring who will crush the serpent, in the same chapter as the fall. Why is that already good news? CORE

Leader. The rescue was not a backup plan. On the day sin entered, God promised a Deliverer. The Creator would not abandon what He made. Jesus came to die. That promise was Plan A.

5. Isaiah 43:7 says God formed a people for His glory. Where do people in our town look for a glory that only God should have?

Leader. Work, a child's sports, a relationship, a reputation, even ministry success. Those are idol factories. Name them without a confession circle. The cure is worship of the true God, not a better self.

5 · SAY IT · 5 MIN

In one sentence

You were made by God and for God, and Jesus came to bring rebels back to Him.

Ask for two volunteers, not the whole circle. They may look at the sentence, then try it without looking. Clumsy and true is the goal.

6 · THIS WEEK · 5 MIN

Missional challenge

Before next week, carry this word to someone far from Jesus — a neighbor, a classmate, a coworker, a friend. Do it with a real action and with a true sentence. Name the person before you pray.

Invite a neighbor to your table this week and learn their name. See them as someone God made on purpose. Say that God made them for Himself, and Jesus came so sinners could know Him.

Leader. See them, share a table, and talk about the Maker. A meal that never names Jesus is not the whole challenge. Tell them God made them, as Genesis says, and Jesus came so sinners could know Him. Next week, before the icebreaker, take one minute. Who went, and what happened? One sentence. No speeches.

7 • PRAY • 8 MIN

Pray these, and leave room for others

1. Father, You made the heavens with Your fingers, and You made every person in this room. We worship You.
2. Forgive us for living as if we were the center. You alone are worthy.
3. Send us to one neighbor this week with a table and a true word about Jesus.

Before you stumble

Read Genesis as it is written. In six days the Lord made heaven and earth, the sea, and all that is in them, and He rested on the seventh (Genesis 1; Exodus 20:11). He made man male and female in His image. Do not turn the days into a symbol. If someone wants to argue past the text, do not hand them the hour. Say what God said and return to Psalm 8. Do not skip to the fall in the first five minutes. The Maker has to be clear before the bad news lands. Do not turn this into journaling about identity. The text speaks.

WITH STUDENTS

Ask which is harder to believe: that they are small under the sky, or that God crowned them and cares. Then read verse 4 again. The answer is in the text, not in how they feel.

IF YOU STILL HAVE TIME

John 1:1-5. The Word who made all things is the Word who took on flesh. Read it and stop. Jesus was there at creation. This was never a backup plan.